

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



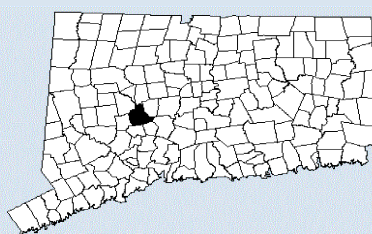
Waterbury School District

Verna Ruffin, Superintendent • 203-574-8004 • www.waterbury.k12.ct.us

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	61
Enrollment	18,956
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$18,405
Total Expenditures ¹	\$354,885,488

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	9,848	52.0	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	92	0.5	0.2
Asian	300	1.6	5.2
Black or African American	3,993	21.1	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	11,853	62.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	799	4.2	4.7
White	1,919	10.1	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	3,745	19.8	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	15,302	80.7	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	3,733	19.7	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	2,283	26.2	995	10.2
Male	2,572	27.5	1,531	14.6
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0	*
Black or African American	1,003	26.2	755	17.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3,175	28.0	1,467	11.5
White	382	21.4	164	8.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	920	23.2	408	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	4,319	29.5	2,277	13.9
Students with Disabilities	1,363	36.9	712	16.1
District	4,855	26.9	2,526	12.5
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 8,640

Number of school-based arrests: 27

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	1,144.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	104.6
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	185.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	333.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	34.2
School Level	82.7
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	22.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	60.3
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	102.6
School Nurses	30.2
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	837.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	2	0.1	0.1
Asian	23	1.5	1.4
Black or African American	94	6.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	169	10.8	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	11	0.7	0.3
White	1,270	80.9	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	16.9	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	260	87.0	303	96.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	589	87.4	623	93.8
White	115	78.8	131	88.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	139	79.0	148	88.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	847	88.8	930	94.8
Students with Disabilities	195	86.3	273	94.1
District	1,028	86.1	1,122	93.8
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	178	37.2
Emotional Disability	63	32.8
Intellectual Disability	19	15.4
Learning Disability	1,029	72.1
Other Health Impairment	371	64.6
Other Disabilities	42	25.1
Speech/Language Impairment	396	87.2
District	2,098	61.4
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	492	2.7	2.6
Emotional Disability	192	1.0	1.1
Intellectual Disability	125	0.7	0.6
Learning Disability	1,428	7.8	6.4
Other Health Impairment	578	3.1	3.5
Other Disabilities	335	1.8	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	471	2.6	2.0
All Disabilities	3,621	19.7	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	180	5.0	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	147	4.1	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$189,528,275	\$9,829	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$9,432,909	\$506	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$75,391,307	\$4,047	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$10,920,040	\$586	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$14,209,219	\$763	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$3,412,173	\$183	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$17,949,471	\$963	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$19,999,756	\$1,340	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$14,042,338	\$754	\$213
Total	\$354,885,488	\$18,405	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$18,982,440	25.5	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	.	.	10.2
Other Salaries	\$12,357,244	16.6	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$14,743,492	19.8	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$6,766,993	9.1	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$11,625,978	15.6	22.2
Supplies	\$539,132	0.7	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$9,146,305	12.3	8.4
Equipment	\$142,034	0.2	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$3,815	0.0	0.1
Total	\$74,307,433	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		20.9	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	23.9
State	57.3
Federal	18.4
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	43	56.5	43	55.0	24	56.9
Asian	121	65.6	121	59.0	50	54.9
Black or African American	1,869	52.0	1,862	42.6	816	44.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5,341	50.1	5,326	43.4	2,186	45.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	362	53.6	358	45.3	151	47.6
White	921	59.8	919	53.9	384	55.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,932	44.3	1,930	40.6	776	41.9
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	6,725	54.1	6,699	45.9	2,835	48.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	7,287	50.6	7,260	43.3	3,017	45.7
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,370	58.8	1,369	52.6	594	52.4
Students with Disabilities	1,796	37.5	1,782	30.6	777	36.5
Students without Disabilities	6,861	55.7	6,847	48.4	2,834	49.7
High Needs	7,718	50.3	7,690	43.1	3,194	45.5
Non-High Needs	939	65.6	939	57.8	417	56.8
District	8,657	51.9	8,629	44.7	3,611	46.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	85.8	86.2	85.6	77.8	5,109	84.1
Curl Up	82.1	90.7	83.7	74.0	5,108	83.1
Push Up	72.1	72.6	65.4	58.4	5,104	67.6
Mile Run/PACER	73.9	66.4	48.7	39.8	5,100	58.4
All Tests - District	49.5	52.7	40.1	29.9	5,075	43.9
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	270	79.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	728	80.1
White	161	89.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	188	77.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,013	80.1
Students with Disabilities	292	67.5
District	1,207	81.3
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	369	29.9
Male	189	16.4
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	147	23.9
Hispanic or Latino	255	19.1
White	116	39.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	28	8.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	398	20.6
Students with Disabilities	17	3.3
District	558	23.3
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	54.5	72.6
Male	42.8	74.8
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	49.8	76.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	44.7	64.2
White	60.8	86.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	25.0	55.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	46.7	70.5
Students with Disabilities	32.2	56.9
District	48.5	73.6
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	51.9	75	34.6	50	69.2	63.9
	High Needs Students	50.3	75	33.5	50	67.0	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	44.7	75	29.8	50	59.7	60.2
	High Needs Students	43.1	75	28.8	50	57.5	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	46.8	75	31.2	50	62.5	61.8
	High Needs Students	45.5	75	30.4	50	60.7	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	58.1%	100%	58.1	100	58.1	58.7%
	High Needs Students	57.1%	100%	57.1	100	57.1	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	52.6%	100%	52.6	100	52.6	61.4%
	High Needs Students	52.1%	100%	52.1	100	52.1	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	50.2%	100%	25.1	50	50.2	58.9%
	Oral	48.2%	100%	24.1	50	48.2	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	26.9%	<=5%	6.2	50	12.5	17.7%
	High Needs Students	28.6%	<=5%	2.7	50	5.4	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	90.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	23.3%	75%	15.6	50	31.1	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		79.9%	94%	42.5	50	85.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		81.3%	94%	86.5	100	86.5	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		87.2%	94%	92.8	100	92.8	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		48.5%	75%	64.7	100	64.7	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		93.7% 43.9%	75%	29.2	50	58.5	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		47.6%	60%	39.7	50	79.4	55.0%
Accountability Index				887.2	1450	61.2	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	65.6	50.3	15.3	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	57.8	43.1	14.7	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	56.8	45.5	11.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	87.2%	6.8%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.8
	High Needs Students	98.7
Math	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	98.5
Science	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	97.5

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 41.3

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

The DEI works with and supports the District Equity Leadership Team (DELT), which designs programs and goals to address the domains of curriculum and instruction, Professional Learning, Culture and Climate, Family and Community Partnerships, and Recruitment and retention. Meeting monthly, the DELT includes parents, community partners, WPS staff (certified and uncertified), and district administrators who review data, receive training on DEI topics and strategies, and make recommendations and adjustments to the WPS Equity Strategic plan.

To continue building the capacity of the administrators, educators, and staff, WPS's partner RE-Center provided monthly virtual micro-session workshops on a variety of topics that were open to all WPS employees and to embed equity in professional development sessions with all building administrators on topics from data to MTSS. Staff facilitated, created, or procured over fifty professional development trainings and workshops focused on building the capacity and skills of WPS administrators, educators, and non-certified staff. The district secured an equity training partner, RE-Center, to provide ongoing support, monthly training, and coaching sessions for establishing School Equity Leadership Teams in all 33 sites/programs.

In the Spring, WPS also worked with RECenter to create and train Youth Equity Squad (YES) leaders in five of its high schools. In April, YES students leaders received a day of training, workshops, and support from RECenter coaches and WSP adult advisors. WPS continued to support and maintain two previous educator affiliation groups for social justice educators and WEPA- Hispanic and Latine educators. In addition, this year, a new group was created and supported for LGBTQ+ educators.

Over 140 students have also earned the Seal of Biliteracy. WPS is in its third year of implementing its International Dual Language School, where students learn English and Spanish in a dual immersion model.

Finally, WPS has three inter-district magnet schools: one with a multicultural and science theme and two with an arts theme. Each magnet school attempts to draw at least 30% of its students from neighboring suburbs.

This Spring, the CT SDE approved the Increasing Diversity Plan.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

District officials carefully weigh school and student needs against available funding, including state and federal entitlement grants, to allocate resources. Principals can present school budget requests through their Assistant Superintendents as needed and are encouraged to engage all staff in submitting items necessary for improved culture, climate, and instruction. The district recognizes that only some schools have the same needs. The Chief Academic Officer and Content Supervisors submit budget requests for curriculum development or program enhancement. Some funds are allocated with district-wide impact, while others are related to specific school needs and enrollment. High-poverty schools or schools with special programs may need additional support, older buildings may require updates, and some schools may experience changes in student enrollment. Some schools, such as magnet schools, can access additional funding through the State. All schools have access to additional support through competitive grants and educational partnerships. By carefully considering all aspects of the budget, the district can provide an equitable allocation of resources to all schools and all student